How to configure and upload data to git hub

Uploading data or a project to GitHub is a fundamental skill for any developer. The most robust way to do this is by using the Git Command Line Interface (CLI).

Here is a step-by-step guide to configuring Git and uploading your local files to a GitHub repository. Aidan Nguyen - Medium

1. Prerequisites

Install Git: If you haven't already, download and install Git from git-scm.com.

GitHub Account: Ensure you have an account created on GitHub.

2. Configure Git (One-Time Setup)

Before uploading files, you need to tell Git who you are so your commits are properly attributed to your account. Open your terminal (or Git Bash on Windows) and run these commands:

Bash

```
# Set your username
git config --global user.name "Your Name"

# Set your email address (use the one associated with your GitHub account)
git config --global user.email "your.email@example.com"
```

3. Create a New Repository on GitHub

1. Log in to GitHub.

2. In the top right corner, click the **+** icon and select **New repository**.
   Aidan Nguyen - Medium
3. Give your repository a short, memorable name (e.g., `my-project`).
4. Choose whether to make it **Public** or **Private**.
5. Leave the "Initialize this repository with..." options unchecked for now, as you will be uploading existing files.
6. Click **Create repository**. Aidan Nguyen - Medium

4. Initialize and Upload Your Local Project

Open your terminal and navigate to the folder on your computer where your project files are located.

Step A: Navigate to your project directory

Bash

```
cd path/to/your/project-folder
```

Step B: Initialize Git

This creates a hidden `.git` folder that tracks your project's history.

Bash

```
git init
```

Step C: Add your files to the staging area

The `.` tells Git to stage all the files in your current directory.

Bash

```
git add .
```

Step D: Commit your files

A commit takes a snapshot of your files. The `-m` flag allows you to add a descriptive message.

Bash

```
git commit -m "Initial commit"
```

Step E: Set the main branch (Optional but recommended)

GitHub now uses `main` as the default branch name instead of `master`.

Bash

```
git branch -M main
```

Step F: Link to your GitHub repository

Go to the repository page you just created on GitHub and copy the HTTPS URL. Connect your local directory to this remote repository:

Bash

```
# Replace the URL below with your actual repository URL
git remote add origin https://github.com/your-username/your-repository-name.gi
```

Step G: Push your files to GitHub

Upload your committed files to the remote repository.

Bash

```
git push -u origin main
```

Note: You may be prompted to authenticate with your GitHub credentials during this step.

Alternative: The Web UI Method

If you only have a few files to upload and don't want to use the command line, you can use the web interface:

1. Create a repository on GitHub (check the box to "Add a README file" so the repository initializes).
2. Open the repository, click the **Add file** dropdown, and select **Upload files.** GitHub

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